19.9 Polypharmacy in Older Adults

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I take 11 tablets and I am not sure what each is for." **Objective** • Several doctors prescribing • Duplicate medicines found	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective health self-management** related to complex medication regimen as evidenced by confusion about medicines and duplicates.	Regimen made simpler and the patient understands it.	• Review his medicines with the doctor or pharmacist. • Write out a schedule. • Use a pill organiser. • Get rid of expired and duplicate medicines.	Understands the regimen: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I feel dizzy in the morning." **Objective** • BP drops when he stands • Unsteady when he gets up	**ACTUAL** **Activity intolerance** related to medication side effects as evidenced by dizziness on rising.	Within 1 week, no dizziness when he gets up.	• Report the side effects to the prescriber. • Teach him to get up slowly. • Check BP lying and standing.	No dizziness: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On many drugs • Kidney function reduced	**RISK** **Risk for injury** as evidenced by risk factors: drug interactions and adverse effects.	No adverse drug events.	• Arrange regular medication reviews. • Tell him to report any new symptom. • Keep one up-to-date list of all his medicines.	No events: **goal met**.